BCM Fall 2026 Transom Grant Info Session Chat Q&A

Q: Can our organization be a fiscally sponsored 501c3?
A: No, an organization cannot be fiscally sponsored.

Q: Can a submission target multiple focus areas?
A: It's important to remember that an external reviewer with specific focus area expertise will read applications. While we understand program goals and outcomes can be interdisciplinary, strong applications make the case for their specific area of focus.

Q: Will large institutions, like universities, be able to submit more than one application for different departments/projects, etc.?
A: To ensure equity, we accept only one application per institution. Large institutions, including universities, municipalities, etc., may be permitted to submit more than one proposal with written approval from BCM prior to the start of the LOI submission period.

Q: We applied to both cycles in 2025, declined on both; does that make us eligible?
A: If an organization is declined two consecutive cycles, they must sit out two consecutive cycles. Please email lmcpherson@bcm.org or naidoo@bcm.org to check your eligibility.

Q: Should the fidelity bond coverage be commensurate with the total grant request?
A: Yes, it should be equal to or greater than the annual grant amount.

Q: Should partnerships be informal or formal? Are MOUs or MOAs required for the LOIs or application phase?
A: MOUs and MOAs are not required. We suggest you include any partnerships (formal or informal) relevant to the project you're submitting.

Q: Your website mentions sample application materials. Are we able to access this before the portal opens?
A: Yes, the sample budget template can be found on the Transom webpage.

Q: Is it advisable to have other funding secured if an organization is invited to submit a full application? Would incorporating another funding source into the sustainability plan suffice for other funders?
A: You do not need to have other funding secured before you apply. Strong applications do have diversified funding sources.

Q: If you are changing iterations, can you use data from your previous program if it is applicable
A: Yes, relevant data is welcome with an explanation for how it is being contextualized in the next iteration.